

Hvac Emergency Guide — Action Checklist

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PREVENTIVE MAINTENANCE

- ☐ **Preventive Maintenance, Item 1:** Replace your HVAC air filter every 90 days and write the installation date directly on the filter so you always know exactly when the next replacement is due.
- ☐ **Preventive Maintenance, Item 2:** Hose off the condenser coil on your outdoor unit twice a year, once in early spring before cooling season starts and once in early fall before heating season begins.
- ☐ **Preventive Maintenance, Item 3:** Trim vegetation around your outdoor unit and maintain at least 2 feet of clearance on all sides to ensure proper airflow and prevent the compressor from overheating.
- ☐ **Preventive Maintenance, Item 4:** Schedule a professional tune-up in March or early April to catch problems before peak season starts and to qualify for the 10–20% off-season discount.

SERVICE CALL STRATEGY

- ☐ **Service Call Strategy, Item 1:** Ask for a written quote before any work begins and verify it includes the problem description, parts with part numbers, labor hours and rate, total cost, and warranty terms.
- ☐ **Service Call Strategy, Item 2:** Request a second quote from another company for any repair estimated at more than \$500 to confirm the diagnosis and identify potentially less expensive alternatives.
- ☐ **Service Call Strategy, Item 3:** Ask the technician directly, "What would you do if this were your house?" to shift their recommendation from revenue-maximizing to practically honest.
- ☐ **Service Call Strategy, Item 4:** Never authorize work based on a verbal estimate — insist everything in writing so you have documented recourse if the final bill differs significantly from what was discussed.

SMART SHOPPING TACTICS

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Smart Shopping Tactics, Item 1: Buy air filters in bulk (a 6-pack) to reduce the per-filter cost and ensure you always have a replacement ready when the 90-day mark arrives.

☐ **Smart Shopping Tactics, Item 2:** Clear the condensate drain line yourself using a wet/dry vac or stiff brush to avoid a service call charge for a task that takes under five minutes.

☐ **Smart Shopping Tactics, Item 3:** Confirm the diagnostic fee before the technician arrives and ask whether it gets credited toward any repair work you authorize with the same company.

☐ **Smart Shopping Tactics, Item 4:** Check the company website or call ahead about off-season discounts — most HVAC companies offer 10–20% off spring tune-ups scheduled before May.

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.